

Senior PHP Backend Developer

Nikita Menshutin

Senior Backend Developer (PHP, WordPress, Symfony, Laravel)

Varna, Bulgaria | Open to remote roles worldwide

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Professional Summary

- 15+ years of backend development experience focused on PHP, Laravel, Symfony, and high-performance WordPress solutions.
- Core contributor to Limit Login Attempts Reloaded, a WordPress security plugin with **1M+ active installations**.
- Led migration of a complex SaaS application from PHP 7 to PHP 8, modernizing legacy modules and improving maintainability.
- Experienced in API development, AI integrations (OpenAI API), and scalable systems for media and SaaS platforms.
- WordCamp Sofia 2024 speaker and active WordPress community contributor.

Key Skills

PHP | Laravel | Symfony | WordPress | JavaScript | TypeScript | Python |
ReactJS | MySQL | Redis | Docker | CI/CD | REST API | OpenAI API | Git

Professional Experience

edited.com — Senior Backend Developer / Senior WordPress Developer

Sep 2023 - Present | UK/Bulgaria

One of the largest B2B fashion intelligence portals.

- Architected and developed custom WordPress themes and plugins, including integrations with HubSpot, GTM, and Pendo to support marketing automation and analytics.
- Implemented end-to-end test coverage with Playwright, helping automate QA and reduce pre-release regressions.
- Configured and optimized AI-powered site search with SearchWP, improving search relevance and user experience.
- Established CI/CD workflows and code style standards, improving development consistency and release flow.
- Integrated OpenAI API to deliver AI-powered product features.

Dev Tactics — Senior Backend Developer

Feb 2022 - Sep 2023 | Poland/Germany/USA

- Led the full migration of TestRail, a legacy Test Management Tool, from PHP 7 to PHP 8, including code audit, refactoring, compatibility validation, and rollout.
- Redesigned and implemented REST API v3 for APILayer, documenting it with OpenAPI (Swagger) to reduce onboarding friction for integration partners.
- Built and maintained data-collection integrations for ZenScape across search, maps, and stock data sources within a microservices architecture (Laravel, Symfony, Flask).
- Refactored critical modules in legacy services, decreasing bug volume and simplifying onboarding for new developers.

New Statesman Media Group — Senior Backend Developer

Jun 2020 - Feb 2023 | UK/Bulgaria

Publisher of [newstatesman.com](https://www.newstatesman.com), one of the largest and oldest newspapers and media portals in the UK.

- Developed and maintained high-traffic WordPress properties on LAMP stack, focusing on performance and scalability.
- Built a custom WordPress plugin for in-article polls with BigQuery integration for analytics and reporting.
- Created a content-targeting plugin (PHP/TypeScript) integrated with Permutive.io to support personalized ad campaigns.
- Mentored 2 junior engineers through code reviews and pair programming, supporting their growth to Mid-level roles within 18 months.

Founder & Lead Developer — nikita.global (Freelance)

Mar 2009 - Present

Delivered end-to-end solutions for international clients (including Upwork and Toptal), with a focus on custom WordPress development, e-commerce integrations, and legacy modernization.

- **High-load media project:** Architected and scaled a WordPress platform for a rap magazine with traffic peaks around 1M monthly visitors.
- **E-commerce integrations:** Developed custom WooCommerce payment and warehouse integrations, including marketplace-related workflows (AliExpress, eBay).
- **Mobile product backend:** Built backend services and APIs for a React Native baby-monitoring app with a 4.5-star app-store rating.

Education

- **MBA in Marketing** — Cardiff Metropolitan University of Wales, UK (2012)
- **French Language Course** — Institut International de Langues & Affaires, Rambouillet, France

Certifications

- **PHP Developer, Professional** — Otus (2023)
- **Advanced PHP** — Udemy (2020)
- Plus earlier certifications in Git, TypeScript, and front-end frameworks.

Community

- WordCamp Sofia 2024 speaker, WordPress plugin developer, and translator.
[WordPress Profile](#)
- Contributor to [Limit Login Attempts Reloaded](#) (**1M+ active installations**).
- Creator of ViK Bot, a Telegram bot that warns about planned water outages in Bulgarian cities (since 2019).

Latest CV: - [Web version](#) - [PDF version](#)